

Inherited Guilt

doc-inherited-guilt

Hamartiology · Original Sin · doctrine · divided_lineages

DISPUTED

Supported across many Bible texts

Subject named directly in Scripture

Holds across manuscript variants

Statement under examination

Adam's guilt, not only his corruption, is reckoned to all his natural descendants such that humanity stands legally guilty in him from conception.

In plain language

Paul's argument in Romans 5:12 to 19 sets Adam beside Christ. Through Adam's one trespass, death reached all humans, and through Christ's one act of obedience, justification and life reach the many. The wording is dense with legal vocabulary, especially 'condemnation' (katakrima), the noun for a condemning sentence, and 'righteous act or verdict' (dikaionoma), the noun for a righteous verdict. Verse 19 uses the same verb 'to appoint or render' (kathistemi) twice, once for the many being constituted sinners through the disobedience of the one and once for the many being constituted righteous through the obedience of the one. The verified canon distribution of that verb shows it usually means to appoint or put someone in charge, but it also carries a real sense, to make or cause to be, so in this verse it could mean placed in the status of sinners, a legal verdict, or caused to be sinners, an effect. Romans 5:12 holds the most disputed phrase, 'on the basis of which all sinned' (epi ho pantes hemarton). The verified grammar shows it is the preposition 'on, upon' (epi) with a relative pronoun, which can mean 'because all sinned' or 'in whom all sinned', and the verb 'they sinned' (hemarton) is an aorist (a completed past action) that everywhere else marks a completed personal act of sinning. The narrow question here is whether Adam's guilt itself, not just a corrupted nature, is charged to every descendant from conception. The words supply three honest readings the vocabulary does not rank. One, Adam acts as representative and his guilt is reckoned to all. Two, the whole race shared in Adam's act by being in him. Three, the race inherits corruption and mortality from Adam, seen in 'in Adam all die' in 1 Corinthians 15:22, but each person becomes guilty by his own sinning. Two general statements pull on the third reading, since Ezekiel 18:20 and Deuteronomy 24:16 say in the plain Hebrew that a son does not bear the father's 'iniquity' (avon) and each dies for his own 'sin' (chet). The forensic (courtroom) verdict word 'condemnation' (katakrima) appears only three times in the whole corpus, all in Romans, so its exact ground cannot be triangulated, and the justification word 'justification' (dikaiosis) in verse 18 occurs only twice. The text builds solidarity in Adam, a forensic (legal) consequence reaching all, and parallel constitutions of sinners and righteous, but it does not, by its own wording, separate imputed (legally credited) legal guilt of Adam's act from inherited corruption that issues in personal sin. That is why careful readers land in different places.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H2399	חַטָּא	chet	sin	33
H5375	נָסָא	nasa	to lift	650
H5771	אֲוֹן	avon	iniquity	233

G0076	Ἀδάμ	Adam	Adam	9
G0264	ἁμαρτάνω	hamartanō	to sin	42
G0266	ἁμαρτία	hamartia	sin	
G0268	ἁμαρτωλός	hamartōlos	sinful	47
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G0599	ἀποθνήσκω	apothnēskō	to die	
G0936	βασιλεύω	basileuō	to reign	
G1345	δικαίωμα	dikaiōma	righteous act	10
G1347	δικαίωσις	dikaiōsis	justification	2
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	367
G1909	ἐπί	epi	upon/to/against	918
G2288	θάνατος	thanatos	death	121
G2525	καθίστημι	kathistēmi	to appoint/conduct	21
G2631	κατάκριμα	katakrima	condemnation	3
G2917	κρίμα	krima	judgment	27
G3551	νόμος	nomos	law	
G3739	ὅς	hos	which	1,535
G3900	παράπτωμα	paraptōma	trespass	19
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	
G4183	πολύς	polus	much	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: False

The narrow proposition is that Adam's guilt itself, as distinct from inherited corruption, is legally reckoned to all descendants so that humanity stands guilty in him from conception. The wording of Romans 5:12-19 anchors a real Adam-and-Christ representative structure and supplies forensic (legal, courtroom) vocabulary, but it does not univocally settle the guilt question. Verified morphology shows that in Romans 5:12 the phrase 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' ho) is the preposition 'on' or 'upon' (ἐπί, epi) plus the dative relative pronoun 'which' (ὧ, ho), and the grammar is genuinely open between a causal reading, 'because all sinned', and a relative reading, 'in whom all sinned'. The verb 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton) is third person aorist (a completed past action) active, a form that everywhere else in the corpus marks a completed personal sinning. In Romans 5:19 'they were constituted' or 'were appointed' (κατεστάθησαν, katestathēsan) is the aorist (completed past action) passive of 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi), a verb attested across the canon dominantly for 'appoint' or 'put in charge' but also with a real causal sense, 'render' or 'cause to be', so its sense here is not fixed by the lexicon (the dictionary record of the word). The word 'condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) occurs only three times, all in Romans, so its precise ground cannot be triangulated. The three readings, namely imputed (legally credited) guilt of Adam's act, ontological (sharing-in-being) participation in Adam, and inherited corruption that issues in personal sin, are each lexically defensible. The pattern is materially contested in the wording itself.

Scripture

Rom.5.12 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G3739 ὅς, G0264 ἁμαρτάνω, G1909 ἐπί, G2288 θάνατος

Reasoning. 'Through one man' (δι' ἑνὸς ἀνθρώπου, di' henos anthrōpou), sin entered the world, and death came 'to all humans' (εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους, eis pantas anthrōpous), 'on the basis of which all sinned' (ἐφ' ᾧ πάντες ἥμαρτον, eph' hō pantes hēmarton). The verified morphology shows that 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō) is the preposition 'on' or 'upon' (ἐπί, epi) governing the relative pronoun 'which' (ὧ, hō), parsed as dative (the 'to' or 'in' grammatical form) singular, with the dictionary form 'who, which' (ὅς, hos). That construction is genuinely open. Read as the fixed Koine (everyday New Testament Greek) idiom 'on' or 'upon' (ἐπί, epi) plus the dative, it is causal, 'because all sinned', which points to personal sin. Read as a true relative, with 'which' (ὧ, hō) reaching back to 'one man' (ἐνὸς ἀνθρώπου, henos anthrōpou), it means 'in whom all sinned', which points to participation in Adam. The verb 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton) is third person plural aorist (a completed past action) active indicative (a simple statement of fact), and the same form elsewhere in the corpus, for example 'I have sinned' in the parable of the prodigal son, always marks a completed personal act of sinning, which weighs toward the causal personal reading. The verse establishes the Adam channel but does not, by the words alone, settle imputed (legally credited) guilt.

Rom.5.13 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0266 ἁμαρτία, G3551 νόμος

Reasoning. 'Sin is not reckoned where there is no law' (ἁμαρτία δὲ οὐκ ἐλλογεῖται μὴ ὄντος νόμου, hamartia de ouk ellogeitai mē ontos nomou). 'Is reckoned' (ἐλλογεῖται, ellogeitai) is present passive (ongoing, simple statement done to the subject) of a bookkeeping verb meaning 'to charge to an account'. This creates an internal pressure for a strict imputed (legally credited) guilt reading, because if Adamic guilt were reckoned to every descendant apart from the Mosaic law then 'is reckoned' (ἐλλογεῖται, ellogeitai) here must be limited to personal sin under explicit law rather than the Adamic charge. The lexeme (dictionary word) itself is account-neutral and does not name whose sin is being charged.

Rom.5.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0936 βασιλεύω, G2288 θάνατος, G0076 Ἀδάμ

Reasoning. 'Death reigned from Adam to Moses, even over those who did not sin in the likeness of Adam's transgression' (ἐβασίλευσεν ὁ θάνατος ἀπὸ Ἀδάμ μέχρι Μωϋσέως καὶ ἐπὶ τοὺς μὴ ἁμαρτήσαντας ἐπὶ τῷ ὁμοιώματι τῆς παραβάσεως Ἀδάμ, ebasileusen ho thanatos apo Adam mechri Mōuseōs kai epi tous mē hamartēsantas epi tō homoiōmati tēs parabaseōs Adam). The aorist (completed past action) participle 'those who sinned' (ἁμαρτήσαντας, hamartēsantas) is negated, so death reaches people whose sinning was not patterned on Adam's specific 'transgression' (παράβασις, parabasis, a stepping-across of an explicit command). This shows the consequence of Adam's act extends past personal violation of an explicit command, which is consistent with solidarity in Adam, but the words do not specify whether that solidarity is legal imputation (the crediting of someone else's act to your account) of Adam's guilt or inherited corruption that produces death.

Rom.5.15 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3900 παράπτωμα, G4183 πολὺς, G0599 ἀποθνήσκω

Reasoning. 'By the trespass of the one, the many died' (τῷ τοῦ ἑνὸς παραπτώματι οἱ πολλοὶ ἀπέθανον, tō tou henos paraptōmati hoi polloi apethanon). 'They died' (ἀπέθανον, apethanon) is aorist (completed past action) active of 'to die' (ἀποθνήσκω, apothnēskō), a death verb, and 'trespass' (παράπτωμα, paraptōma) carries the base sense of 'false step', 'slip', 'trespass'. The lexical force locates a corporate outcome in Adam's single trespass, but the verb names dying, not legal sentencing, so this verse contributes solidarity and consequence rather than an explicit forensic (courtroom, legal) imputation (crediting of an act to another's account).

Rom.5.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2917 κρίμα, G2631 κατάκριμα, G1345 δικαίωμα

Reasoning. 'The judgment from one led to condemnation' (τὸ μὲν γὰρ κρίμα ἐξ ἑνὸς εἰς κατάκριμα, to men gar krima ex henos eis katakrima). 'The judgment' (κρίμα, krima), arising 'from one' (ἐξ ἑνὸς, ex henos), leads 'to condemnation' (εἰς κατάκριμα, eis katakrima). 'Condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) is forensic (legal, courtroom language), meaning a condemnatory sentence, and the lexicon (dictionary) glosses it 'condemnation', 'judgement', 'punishment'. This is the strongest single forensic clue that the Adamic consequence has a legal dimension. But the verified canon count for 'condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) is only three, all in Romans, so its precise ground cannot be triangulated, and the genitive (the noun in the 'from-X' or possessive grammatical form) 'from one' (ἐξ ἑνὸς, ex henos) is itself ambiguous between 'out of the one trespass' and 'out of the one man'. The word establishes a legal verdict but not whose specific act grounds it.

Rom.5.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3900 παραπτώμα, G2631 κατάκριμα, G1347 δικαίωσις, G3956 πᾶς, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Reasoning. 'Through one trespass to all humans to condemnation' (δι' ἑνὸς παραπτώματος εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους εἰς κατάκριμα, di' henos paraptōmatos eis pantas anthrōpous eis katakrima), paralleled by 'through one righteous act to all humans to justification of life' (δι' ἑνὸς δικαίωματος εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους εἰς δικαίωσιν ζωῆς, di' henos dikaiōmatos eis pantas anthrōpous eis dikaiōsin zōēs). Through one trespass, condemnation to all humans, matched word for word by through one 'righteous act' (δικαίωμα, dikaiōma), 'justification' (δικαίωσις, dikaiōsis) of life to all humans. The 'to all humans' (εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους, eis pantas anthrōpous) clause is comprehensive, and the structure is exactly symmetrical. Read alone it fits a representative model. Read with its twin clause, the 'all' (πάντες, pantes) on the condemnation side and the 'all' (πάντες, pantes) on the life side must be held to the same scope, which the words do not themselves fix, since 'justification' (δικαίωσις, dikaiōsis) occurs only twice in the whole corpus. The symmetry forces qualification of 'all' (πᾶς, pas) that the lexeme (dictionary word) alone cannot supply.

Rom.5.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2525 καθίστημι, G0268 ἁμαρτωλός, G4183 πολὺς

Reasoning. 'Through the disobedience of the one man the many were constituted sinners' (διὰ τῆς παρακοῆς τοῦ ἑνὸς ἀνθρώπου ἁμαρτωλοὶ κατεστάθησαν οἱ πολλοί, dia tēs parakoēs tou henos anthrōpou hamartōloi katestathēsan hoi polloi), matched by 'through the obedience of the one the many will be constituted righteous' (διὰ τῆς ὑπακοῆς τοῦ ἑνὸς δίκαιοι κατασταθήσονται οἱ πολλοί, dia tēs hupakoēs tou henos dikaiōi katastathēsontai hoi polloi). The verified morphology shows 'they were constituted' (κατεστάθησαν, katestathēsan) is aorist (completed past action) passive, third person plural, of 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi), and the parallel 'they will be constituted' (κατασταθήσονται, katastathēsontai) is the future passive of the same verb. The verified canon distribution of 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi), twenty one occurrences, is dominated by the sense 'appoint' or 'put in charge', 'set over a household or office', but it also carries a real causal sense, 'make' or 'render', as when the tongue is constituted among the members or friendship with the world is rendered enmity. So in verse 19 the verb is genuinely two-valued, either 'were placed in the status of sinners', forensic (legal, courtroom) declarative, or 'were caused to be sinners', effective. The strict structural parallel with the righteous clause, read forensically by justification, presses verse 19a toward a declarative sense, but the parallel is structural and the verb itself remains polysemous (carrying more than one meaning).

1Cor.15.22 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3956 πᾶς, G0076 Ἀδάμ, G0599 ἀποθνήσκω

Reasoning. 'In Adam all die, so also in Christ all shall be made alive' (ἐν τῷ Ἀδὰμ πάντες ἀποθνήσκουσιν, οὕτως καὶ ἐν τῷ Χριστῷ πάντες ζωοποιηθήσονται, en tō Adam pantes apothnēskousin, houtōs kai en tō Christō pantes zōopoiēthēsontai). The verified morphology shows 'they die' (ἀποθνήσκουσιν, apothnēskousin) is present active (ongoing, simple statement of fact), a verb of dying, paralleled by the future passive 'they shall be made alive' (ζωοποιηθήσονται, zōopoiēthēsontai), 'be made alive'. The locative (place-naming) phrase 'in Adam' (ἐν τῷ Ἀδὰμ, en tō Adam) asserts solidarity in Adam as the basis of universal death. The lexical force is universal mortality through union with Adam, with no forensic (courtroom, legal) verb present, so this verse anchors solidarity and a death outcome but says nothing, by its words, about imputed (legally credited) legal guilt.

Ps.51.7 · neutral · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H5771 יוֹן, H2399 חַטָּא

Reasoning. 'In iniquity I was brought forth and in sin my mother conceived me' (בְּעוֹן חוֹלַלְתִּי וּבְחַטָּא יָחַמְתָּנִי אִמִּי, be-avon cholalti u-ve-chet yechemathni immi). This is Psalm 51 verse 7 in the Hebrew versification of the source, the verse numbered Psalm 51:5 in English versification. The verified Hebrew lemmas (dictionary forms) are 'iniquity' (יוֹן, avon) and 'sin' (חַטָּא, chet), naming the speaker's condition from conception. The lexical pattern anchors an innate sinful state at origin, but the words describe a condition belonging to the speaker, not a transfer or reckoning of a prior agent's specific guilt to him.

Ezek.18.20 · complicates · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H5375 נַשָּׂא, H5771 יוֹן

Reasoning. 'The soul that sins, it shall die. A son shall not bear the iniquity of the father' (תְּמוֹת בֶּן לֹא יִשָּׂא בְּעוֹן הָאָב, ha-nephesh ha-chote't hi tamut ben lo yissa ba-avon ha-av). The soul that sins, it shall die. A son shall not 'bear' (נָשָׂא, yissa, from 'to bear, carry' (נָשָׂא, nasa)), the 'iniquity' (יוֹן, avon), of the father. The verified Hebrew uses the verb 'to bear or carry' (נָשָׂא, nasa) with 'iniquity' (יוֹן, avon) as object, an explicit statement that one person does not carry another person's guilt. This is a complicating principle for an imputed (legally credited) Adamic guilt reading, because the verb is the standard term for bearing guilt and the principle is stated in general terms. The store records a verified cross reference from Romans 5:12 to the companion verse Ezekiel 18:4 with eleven votes, so the chain is real in the data.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Rom.5.12	Rom.5.19	openbible	44
Rom.5.12	1Cor.15.21	openbible	73
Rom.5.12	Rom.3.23	openbible	32
Rom.5.12	1John.1.8	openbible	17
Rom.5.12	Ps.51.5	openbible	21
Rom.5.12	Ezek.18.4	openbible	11
Rom.5.18	1Cor.15.22	openbible	18
1Cor.15.22	1Cor.15.45	openbible	14
Rom.5.15	Rom.5.12	tsk	1
Rom.5.16	Gen.3.6	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Ezek.18.20 · addressed

The verified Hebrew states that a son does not 'bear' (נָשָׂא, nasa, to bear or carry) the 'iniquity' (אָוֶן, avon) of the father, using the standard term for carrying guilt. This is a general juridical (court-of-law) principle that one agent's guilt is not transferred to another. A representative reading answers that Adam's case is structurally unique because he is the one through whom the whole race came, not merely an individual father, so the Ezekiel principle and the Adam parallel address different relations. The complication remains material because the Ezekiel statement is stated generally and uses the very vocabulary of bearing guilt that an imputation (legal crediting) reading needs. The store confirms a real cross reference chain from Romans 5:12 to Ezekiel 18:4.

Deut.24.16 · addressed

The verified Hebrew reads 'each shall be put to death for his own sin' (אִישׁ בְּחַטָּאוֹ יוּמָתוֹ, ish be-chet'o yumathu), with 'sin' (חַטָּא, chet), and the verb 'to die or kill' (מוֹת, muth) for capital punishment, denying that fathers die for sons or sons for fathers. This is the same personal responsibility principle as Ezekiel 18:20 in Torah form, and it is a material complication because it makes legal death personal in the plain wording. A representative reading restricts it to civil-judicial penalty among humans rather than the Adamic relation, which is exegetically (in detailed interpretation of the text) possible but not stated by the words themselves, so the tension stays visible.

Rom.5.12 · addressed

The verified verb 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton) is aorist (a completed past action) active third plural, a form that everywhere else in the corpus marks completed personal sinning. If the proposition required all to have personally committed Adam's specific act, this aorist would be straightforward, but Adam is one and the 'all' (πάντες, pantes) are many. So the aorist must either describe corporate participation in Adam's act, which strains the ordinary aorist sense, or describe each person's own sinning, which weakens a strict imputation (legal crediting) reading. This unresolved grammatical pull is the heart of the dispute and is addressed but not dissolved by the lexicon (dictionary record).

Rom.9.11 · addressed

'For before they were born or had done anything good or bad' (μήπω γὰρ γεννηθέντων μηδὲ πράξαντων τι ἀγαθὸν ἢ φαῦλον, mēpō gar gennēthentōn mēde praxantōn ti agathon ē phaulon), before being born and before having done anything good or bad. Paul can discuss persons as not yet having performed personal acts, which shows that personal moral status is a category he treats apart from any imputed (legally credited) Adamic guilt. A representative reading notes Paul is here addressing election rather than Adamic imputation, which is consistent, but the verse does establish that the vocabulary of personal performance is available in Paul and is not collapsed into Adamic reckoning.

Concordance traversed

G0076, G0264, G0268, G2525, G2631, G2917, G3900, G1345, G1347, G1520, G1909, G3739, G2288, H5375, H5771, H2399

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The anchor verses Romans 5:12-19 and 1 Corinthians 15:22 fall outside the ingested ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window, which covers only 3 John, so no CBGM (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, a manuscript-comparison technique) apparatus was examined and none was invented. The readings 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō) in Romans 5:12 and 'they were constituted' (κατεστάθησαν, katestathēsan) in Romans 5:19 are stable across the manuscript tradition. The dispute over inherited guilt is interpretive and grammatical, not text critical, so the verdict is variant robust (holds up across the manuscript variants).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. federal_headship, realist_semiinal_headship, mediate_imputation, corruption_without_imputed_guilt

federal_headship: affirms_proposition · Reads 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō) as relative, 'in whom all sinned', or as causal in the sense that in Adam's representative act all are counted as having sinned. Reads 'they were constituted sinners' (κατεστάθησαν ἁμαρτωλοί, katestathēsan hamartōloi) in verse 19 as forensic (legal, courtroom) declarative, 'were constituted in the status of sinners', in strict parallel to 'they will be constituted righteous' (δικαίοι κατασταθήσονται, dikaiōi katastathēsontai), which justification reads as a declarative reckoning. The 'judgment from one to condemnation' (κρίμα ἐξ ἑνὸς εἰς κατάκριμα, krima ex henos eis katakrima) of verse 16 supplies the legal verdict. On this reading Adam's one trespass is judicially reckoned to all he represents, which is exactly imputed (legally credited) guilt. Strongest lexical support is the symmetrical 'to all humans' (εἰς πάντας ἀνθρώπους, eis pantas anthrōpous) of verse 18 and the twin 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi) clauses of verse 19.

realist_seminal_headship: affirms_with_modification · Reads 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō) as relative or modal (mode-naming), 'in whom all sinned', taken as actual ontological (sharing-in-being) participation, the whole race seminally present in Adam at the trespass. On this reading the guilt of all in Adam is real but its basis is participation rather than legal representation. The aorist (completed past action) 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton) is honored as a real completed act in which all shared by being in Adam. This lens affirms that all are truly guilty in Adam but grounds it differently than a purely representative reckoning.

mediate_imputation: affirms_with_modification · Reads the chain as inherited corruption first, which is the immediate ground, with condemnation following upon the corrupt condition that all share from Adam. 'Condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) and 'sinners they were constituted' (ἁμαρτωλοί κατεστάθησαν, hamartōloi katestathēsan) are taken to describe a real guilt of the race, but mediated through the propagated corrupt nature rather than the direct reckoning of Adam's discrete act. This lens affirms inherited guilt while ordering it after corruption, so it sits between strict imputation (legal crediting) and the corruption-only reading.

corruption_without_imputed_guilt: denies_proposition · Reads 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō) as the fixed Koine (everyday New Testament Greek) causal idiom, 'because all sinned', and reads 'they were constituted sinners' (κατεστάθησαν ἁμαρτωλοί, katestathēsan hamartōloi) as effective, 'were made to be sinners' through an inherited corruption that issues in actual personal sin. Holds that the race inherits Adamic corruption and mortality, the 'in Adam' (ἐν τῷ Ἀδᾶμ, en tō Adam) death of 1 Corinthians 15:22, but that guilt is incurred upon personal sinning, with Ezekiel 18:20 and Deuteronomy 24:16 as the governing principle that one does not bear another's guilt. 'Condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) in verse 18 is anchored in the consequence pattern of a corrupted humanity that all sin, not in legal reckoning of Adam's specific act. This lens is fairly served by the dominant attested sense of 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi), 'cause to be', and by the aorist (completed past action) 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton) as personal sinning.

The proposition is narrower than inherited corruption. Many who affirm an inherited corrupt nature deny inherited guilt. The verified lexical pattern in Romans 5 establishes a strong Adam and Christ representative structure, anchors 'condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) as forensic (legal, courtroom language), and sets 'they were constituted' (κατεστάθησαν, katestathēsan) and 'they will be constituted' (κατασταθήσονται, katastathēsontai) in strict parallel. But the lexicon (the dictionary record of words) alone does not force the imputed (legally credited) guilt reading over the realist, the mediate, or the corruption-only readings. The decision turns on disambiguating 'on the basis of which' (ἐφ' ᾧ, eph' hō), the attested polysemy (multiple-meaning quality) of 'to appoint, to render' (καθίστημι, kathistēmi) between appoint-to-a-status and cause-to-be, the unfixable scope of 'all' (πᾶς, pas) across the twin clauses of verse 18 given that 'justification' (δικαίωσις, dikaiōsis) is a near hapax (a word that occurs only once or twice in the entire corpus), and the weight of the general personal responsibility principle of Ezekiel 18:20 and Deuteronomy 24:16.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Scripture's lexical pattern on the relation between Adam's sin and his descendants includes forensic (legal, courtroom) vocabulary, 'judgment' (κρίμα, krima) and 'condemnation' (κατάκριμα, katakrima) and 'righteous act or verdict' (δικαίωμα, dikaiōma), a status verb of two senses, 'sinners they were constituted'

(ἁμαρτωλοὶ κατεστάθησαν, hamartōloi katestathēsan), and language of solidarity, 'in Adam' (ἐν τῷ Ἀδάμ, en tō Adam) and the aorist (completed past action) 'they sinned' (ἥμαρτον, hēmarton).

The stem builds in a specific taxonomy (classification scheme) that partitions guilt from corruption and fixes legal reckoning at conception. That partition is itself a framework-specific construct, and the verified text supplies a representative structure between Adam and Christ without lexically separating guilt from corruption with the precision the stem assumes, nor specifying conception as the moment. The verdict is rendered on the original stem and remains disputed because the wording is materially contested. Affirms is unchanged from the prior evidence.

Citations

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